Project Theme: Student Life, Fixed

Campus Unleashed Hackathon · with a green twist

The challenge

Build a **Chrome extension** that shows a student the real cost of their time online and their AI use: in **minutes**, and in the **energy, carbon and water** behind it.

It must be **private**: everything stays on the user's own laptop. No accounts, no server.

Why this theme? Students spend hours in the browser and use AI every day, but almost nobody sees what that adds up to. Your extension makes it visible without collecting anyone's data. And you can test it on the best user you have: yourself.

The core

Build these first. How far you take each one is up to you.

1. **Track browser time.** Active time per website. Stop counting when the user is idle or Chrome isn't in focus.
2. **Hourly reminder.** After an hour of active use, show a notification. Let the user change the interval.
3. **Spot AI use.** Recognise ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude and others. Count prompts if you can. If not, find another honest way: time on the site, or a "+1 prompt" button.
4. **Estimate the footprint.** Turn AI use into energy (Wh), carbon (gCO_2e) and water (mL).
5. **Show a dashboard.** Today, this week, and how it's changing.
6. **Stay private.** Keep all data in the browser's local storage. Send nothing anywhere.

> **Your own spin is welcome.** Improvements that fit the theme are rewarded, so don't just tick the list.

About the numbers

Nobody knows exactly what one prompt costs. These are the best-known figures, per text prompt:

Source	Energy	CO_2e	Water
Gemini, median text prompt (Google, Aug 2025)	0.24 Wh	0.03 g	0.26 mL
ChatGPT, average query (OpenAI's CEO, June 2025)	0.34 Wh	not given	0.32 mL

- These are **company figures**, not independently checked. Other studies get very different results.
- It depends on **what is counted**. Counting only the chips, Google gets 0.10 Wh for the same prompt.
- Long answers, images, files and "deep research" cost **much more** than a short text prompt.

So be honest in your tool. Show a range, or say which figure you used and why. Handling the uncertainty well earns points.

Sources: Google, "Measuring the environmental impact of delivering AI at Google scale" (arXiv 2508.15734). Sam Altman, "The Gentle Singularity" (blog, June 2025).

Go further

Pick one or more, roughly from simple to ambitious. Or invent your own.

- **Focus sessions:** a study timer that mutes the reminders and tracks the session.
- **Goals and streaks:** "under 4 hours of browsing today", with a streak counter.
- **Weekly report:** this week compared to last week.
- **Prompt cost meter:** a small badge on AI sites with today's running total.
- **Greener tips** based on the data: "short prompts use less", "close unused tabs".
- **Real-life comparisons:** "your AI use today = charging your phone X times". Show your maths.
- **Grid setting:** let the user pick their country's electricity carbon level.
- **Export and delete:** all data out, or wiped, in one click. Proof that it's private.
- **Stretch:** a Firefox build, a phone companion, or an opt-in class leaderboard with anonymous totals only.

Project rules

1. It must **run in Chrome**.
2. It must **not collect, store or send other people's data**.
3. **Read only what your feature needs.** Counting a prompt means noticing that one was *sent*, not reading *what* was typed.
4. Ask only for the **permissions** you use, and be ready to explain what your code can see, and why.
5. The **event rules** still apply: start from scratch after 18:30 on Friday, and declare your AI tools in the README.

How you're judged

The project is **60 of your 100 points**. What the judges look for in *this* project:

Criterion	Points	What it means here
Idea and theme fit	12	Does it make students think about their screen time and AI use? What's your own twist?
Technical execution	15	Does the time tracking handle idle and focus? Are the footprint numbers sourced and explained?
Usability	10	Can a new student install it and understand the dashboard in a minute?
Demo and presentation	10	A clear, well-structured demo of the extension in action
Understanding	8	Can you explain your code, and exactly what it can see?
Code and repository	5	A clear README (how to load it, your AI declaration) and organised code
Total	**60**	

Handover: see the event leaflet. Submit by **Saturday 14:25**.

Simple and working beats big and broken. Good luck, and have fun!